Caesar, Legion's Emperor — Legion March

Bracket 3 · 3/3 Game Changers · the commander makes the army · 100 cards

Nonland 64	**Avg MV** 2.74	**Token makers** 17	**Protection** 7	**Payoffs** 11

COMMANDER (1)

1 Caesar, Legion's Emperor {1}{R}{W}{B} 4

LANDS (34)

1 Arid Mesa
1 Badlands {B}{R}
1 Battlefield Forge {W}{R}
1 Blackcleave Cliffs {B}{R}
1 Blightstep Pathway {B}{R}
1 Blood Crypt {B}{R}
1 Bloodstained Mire
1 Brightclimb Pathway {B}{W}
1 Castle Ardenvale {W}
1 Caves of Koilos {B}{W}
1 Clifftop Retreat {R}{W}
1 Command Tower {B}{R}{W}
1 Concealed Courtyard {B}{W}
1 Diamond City
1 Dragonskull Summit {B}{R}
1 Godless Shrine {B}{W}
1 Inspiring Vantage {R}{W}
1 Isolated Chapel {B}{W}
1 Kher Keep
1 Marsh Flats
1 Mountain {R}
1 Needleverge Pathway {R}{W}
1 Nomad Outpost {B}{R}{W}
1 Phyrexian Tower {B}
3 Plains {W}
1 Plateau {R}{W}
1 Sacred Foundry {R}{W}
1 Scrubland {B}{W}
1 Sulfurous Springs {B}{R}
2 Swamp {B}
1 Windbrisk Heights {W}

RAMP & MANA (6)

1 Arcane Signet {2} 2
1 Pitiless Plunderer {3}{B} 4
1 Smothering Tithe {3}{W} 4
1 Sol Ring {1} 1
1 Talisman of Hierarchy {2} 2
1 Talisman of Indulgence {2} 2

CARD DRAW (8)

1 Black Market Connections {2}{B} 3
1 Bloodline Recollector {1}{B}{B} 2
1 Commissar Severina Raine {1}{W}{B} 3
1 Demonic Tutor {1}{B} 2
1 Idol of Oblivion {2} 2
1 Morbid Opportunist {2}{B} 3
1 Skullclamp {1} 1
1 Tocasia's Welcome {2}{W} 3

REMOVAL & INTERACTION (6)

1 Anguished Unmaking {1}{W}{B} 3
1 Chainsaw {1}{R} 2
1 Lich's Relic {B} 1
1 Path to Exile {W} 1
1 Swords to Plowshares {W} 1
1 Vanishing Verse {W}{B} 2

BOARD WIPES (2)

1 Ruinous Ultimatum {R}{R}{W}{W}{W}{B}{B} 7
1 The Meathook Massacre {X}{B}{B} 2

PROTECTION (7)

1 Deflecting Swat {2}{R} 3
1 Flawless Maneuver {2}{W} 3
1 General's Enforcer {W}{B} 2
1 Mithril Coat {3} 3
1 Mother of Runes {W} 1
1 Swiftfoot Boots {2} 2
1 Teferi's Protection {2}{W} 3

TOKEN ENGINES (13)

1 Adeline, Resplendent Cathar {1}{W}{W} 3
1 Anim Pakal, Thousandth Moon {1}{R}{W} 3
1 Assemble the Legion {3}{R}{W} 5
1 Bitterbloom Bearer {B}{B} 2
1 Bitterblossom {1}{B} 2
1 Court of Grace {2}{W}{W} 4
1 Hero of Bladehold {2}{W}{W} 4
1 Infantry Shield {2}{R} 3
1 Legion Warboss {2}{R} 3
1 Loyal Apprentice {1}{R} 2
1 Myrel, Shield of Argive {3}{W} 4
1 Ocelot Pride {W} 1
1 Secure the Wastes {X}{W} 1

TOKEN & TRIGGER DOUBLERS (5)

1 Anointed Procession {3}{W} 4
1 Elspeth, Storm Slayer {3}{W}{W} 5
1 Isshin, Two Heavens as One {R}{W}{B} 3
1 Mondrak, Glory Dominus {2}{W}{W} 4
1 Windcrag Siege {1}{R}{W} 3

SACRIFICE OUTLETS (4)

1 Ashnod's Altar {3} 3
1 Goblin Bombardment {1}{R} 2
1 Phyrexian Altar {3} 3
1 Viscera Seer {B} 1

DRAIN & DEATH PAYOFFS (13)

1 Bastion of Remembrance {2}{B} 3
1 Blood Artist {1}{B} 2
1 Cruel Celebrant {W}{B} 2
1 Dictate of Erebos {3}{B}{B} 5
1 Elas il-Kor, Sadistic Pilgrim {W}{B} 2
1 Grave Pact {1}{B}{B}{B} 4
1 Impact Tremors {1}{R} 2
1 Ingris Stingerquill {B}{R}{R} 3
1 Mayhem Devil {1}{B}{R} 3
1 Purphoros, God of the Forge {3}{R} 4
1 Warleader's Call {1}{R}{W} 3
1 Zulaport Cutthroat {1}{B} 2
1 Zurgo Stormrender {R}{W}{B} 3

RECURSION (1)

1 Reassembling Skeleton {1}{B} 2

CAESAR, LEGION'S EMPEROR — PILOT'S GAMEPLAN

0. The one-paragraph version

The commander makes the army. Every turn you attack, Caesar lets you sacrifice one creature and get two hasty Soldiers already attacking, plus a card or a burn. You never need to draw a token maker to have a board. The deck's job is to **keep Caesar alive**, **double what he makes**, and **turn every death into drain**. Warriors that mobilize makes are sacrificed at your end step, so each attack also leaves a pile of free deaths for Blood Artist, Zulaport and Grave Pact.

1. The curve you actually have

	MV1	MV2	MV3	MV4	MV5	MV7	avg
Nonland in the 99 (64)	8	21	22	9	3	1	**2.74**

Nothing between 5 and 7, and 51 of 64 nonland cards cost 3 or less. The one 7 is Ruinous Ultimatum, the one-sided wipe.

2. How Caesar works — the three rules that matter

1. **He doesn't have to attack.** "*Whenever you attack*" triggers when you attack with anything

(CR 508.3d). If Caesar is unprotected, keep him home and attack with a token.

1. **No sacrifice means nothing happens.** The two modes only come if you sacrifice another

creature. Always have one spare body before combat.

1. **His Soldiers enter attacking but never "attacked."** They don't trigger Caesar again, or

Adeline, Anim Pakal, Myrel or mobilize. They **do** trigger Impact Tremors, Warleader's Call, Elas and Tocasia's Welcome as they enter.

Which two modes

Situation	Pick
Early, building up	**Tokens + draw.** +1 body and +1 card every turn.
Board is wide, one opponent is low	**Tokens + damage.** The damage counts the two Soldiers you just made.
Soldiers would just die (a blocker wall, a wipe coming)	**Draw + damage.**

What to sacrifice to him, best first

Mobilize Warriors (they die at end step anyway) → Legion Warboss's Goblin → a spare 1/1 token → Reassembling Skeleton (it comes back) → anything else. **Never a drainer.**

3. Opening

T1–T2: Ocelot Pride, Mother of Runes, Viscera Seer, Bitterblossom, Bitterbloom Bearer, Loyal Apprentice, General's Enforcer, a Talisman, Skullclamp.

T3: Adeline, Anim Pakal, Lingering Souls, Legion Warboss, Isshin, Infantry Shield, Swiftfoot Boots, Windcrag Siege (choose **Mardu**).

T4: Caesar, ideally with Boots, Mithril Coat, General's Enforcer or Mother of Runes ready. Attack the same turn with anything that isn't summoning sick. He doesn't need haste, because the trigger is "whenever you attack."

T5–T6: a token doubler (Anointed Procession, Mondrak, Elspeth), Grave Pact / Dictate, Assemble the Legion, Court of Grace.

Mulligans. Keep 3 lands with 2 colours and one cheap creature, because Caesar needs one other body. You don't need a token maker in the opener: Caesar is always in the command zone.

4. Protecting Caesar

Threat	Answer
Targeted destroy/damage	Swiftfoot Boots (hexproof), Mother of Runes, Mithril Coat, General's Enforcer, Deflecting Swat
Targeted exile (Swords, Path, Chaos Warp)	Indestructible doesn't help. Use **Swiftfoot Boots, Mother of Runes or Deflecting Swat**
Destroy wipe	Mithril Coat, General's Enforcer, **Flawless Maneuver (free with Caesar out)**
Anything / everything	Teferi's Protection
Instant-speed removal on your turn	Myrel: opponents can't cast spells during your turn

Diamond City (land) can also move its shield counter onto Caesar on any turn two or more creatures entered. With this deck that's nearly every turn.

5. The engines to look for

- **Isshin or Windcrag Siege + Caesar = two Caesar triggers.** Sacrifice twice: 4 Soldiers and two

sets of modes. With both out it's three triggers.

- **A token doubler + Caesar = 4 Soldiers per trigger.** Add Isshin and it's 8 Soldiers plus two

cards per attack.

- **Infantry Shield on Caesar = mobilize 4.** Four Warriors attack, then all four die at your end

step. That's four deaths for every drainer and four sacrifices per opponent under Grave Pact. With a doubler it's eight.

- **Skullclamp on any 1/1 = draw two** when it dies. Warleader's Call makes your tokens 2/2, and a

clamped 2/2 doesn't die. That's a real cost, not a reason to skip the anthem.

6. Sequencing within your turn

1. **Upkeep:** Bitterblossom, Bitterbloom Bearer, Assemble the Legion, Court of Grace.
2. **Main 1:** equip Infantry Shield and Boots, cast doublers and Isshin **before** combat.
3. **Beginning of combat:** Loyal Apprentice's Thopter and Legion Warboss's Goblin arrive.
4. **Declare attackers.** Caesar, Adeline, Anim Pakal, Myrel, Hero of Bladehold and mobilize all

trigger. **Put Myrel's trigger on the stack first, so it resolves last.** Caesar's Soldiers then exist before Myrel counts your Soldiers.

1. **Main 2:** sacrifice surplus Warriors to Ashnod's Altar for mana, or Skullclamp one. They die at

end step anyway.

1. **End step:** mobilize Warriors are sacrificed. That's a death each, Zurgo drains 1 per Warrior,

and Grave Pact / Dictate make each opponent sacrifice per death.

7. The kill

- **Drain:** every death pays Blood Artist, Zulaport, Cruel Celebrant, Bastion, Elas, Meathook and

Zurgo (Zurgo only for tokens). Every creature entering pays Impact Tremors and Warleader's Call. A doubled Caesar attack with Warleader's Call out is 4 Soldiers entering, so 4 to each opponent, before anything dies.

- **Combat:** tokens arrive already attacking, with Hero's battle cry and Warleader's +1/+1. You

can also finish with Caesar's damage mode: damage equal to your token count at one opponent.

- **Grave Pact / Dictate lock:** every end-step Warrior sacrifice clears one creature from each

opponent. They run out of blockers quickly.

8. The declared combo (assembles ~turn 6–7)

Pitiless Plunderer + Reassembling Skeleton + Ashnod's Altar (or Phyrexian Altar).

Sacrifice the Skeleton to the Altar, get a Treasure from Plunderer, and pay 1 to return it. Ashnod's version nets ◇ each loop; Phyrexian's nets zero. Each loop is a death, so every drainer fires and Grave Pact makes each opponent sacrifice. **Announce each iteration and let opponents respond; stop when the table is dead.** Cut Reassembling Skeleton to switch this off.

9. Mistakes to avoid

1. **Attacking with no spare body.** Caesar's trigger needs *another* creature to sacrifice.
2. **Attacking with an unprotected Caesar.** He doesn't need to attack; send a token.
3. **Expecting Swords / Path to be stopped by indestructible.** Only hexproof, protection or

Deflecting Swat stop exile.

1. **Ordering Myrel's trigger wrong.** Let Caesar's Soldiers arrive first.
2. **The Meathook Massacre with X ≥ 1 hits your own tokens too.** Usually cast it for X = 0 as a

drain enchantment, unless the deaths are the point.

1. **Ruinous Ultimatum is .** Plan for it from turn 5 on. Talismans and

Command Tower help.

1. **Teferi's Protection phases out your whole board**, Caesar and doublers included, until your

next turn.

1. **Windcrag Siege: choose Mardu**, not Jeskai. Mardu is the attack-trigger doubler.